



DESTRUCTION OUTSIDE ATLANTA

Despite assuming the offensive on four separate occasions, John Bell Hood could not stall William T. Sherman's four-month Atlanta campaign. On September 2, 1864, Hood evacuated the city, his troops destroying anything that might aid the Union war effort. Military installations and supplies were burned, and nearby railroad tracks torn up. Hood and his men retreated deeper into Georgia, leaving Sherman to wreak yet more havoc on the beleaguered city.